

A CRM APPLICATION FOR THE CHAI SHOP & CO

3. PROJECT DESIGN PHASE

3.1 Problem–Solution Fit

The project addresses manual customer and sales record keeping at TheChaiShop&Co by replacing scattered registers and spreadsheet files with a centralized, automated CRM. Cloud storage prevents data loss, validation rules reduce entry errors, automated billing removes calculation mistakes, and real-time reports and dashboards eliminate reporting delays, giving accurate and timely business insights.

3.2 Proposed Solution

Aspect	Design
Problem	Manual order, billing and customer records cause calculation errors, delayed reports, data loss and missed customer communication.
Solution	A Salesforce-based CRM application with centralized customer, employer and enterprise records and controlled, role-based access.
Innovation	Structured digital records, validation rules, automated billing through formula fields, scheduled flows for birthday offer emails, and real-time reporting.
Impact	Improved data accuracy, faster reporting, reduced manual work and stronger customer engagement and loyalty.
Business Model	Digital customer relationship management and sales analytics platform for retail and enterprise tea customers.
Scalability	Can support more users, branches and growing customer data on the Salesforce cloud without loss of performance.

3.3 Four-Layer Architecture

Layer	Components	Purpose
1. Presentation	Salesforce Lightning UI, custom tabs and Lightning App	Provides screens for users to create, view and manage CRM records from a single application.
2. Application	Validation rules, record types, page layouts and Flows	Applies business rules, controls data entry and automates calculations and email notifications.

3. Data	Employer Account, Customer Account and Enterprise Account custom objects	Stores structured customer, employer and enterprise data in Salesforce Cloud.
---------	--	---

1

Layer	Components	Purpose
4. Analytics	Reports and Dashboards	Converts stored sales and customer data into operational and management insights.

3.4 Object and Relationship Design

- Customer Account is connected to Employer Account through a Lookup relationship (Associated Employer).
- Enterprise Account is also connected to Employer Account through a Lookup relationship (Associated Employer).
- Customer Account uses two Record Types, Online Order and Walk-In Order, each with its own page layout.
- Global picklists such as Payment Mode and Products Purchased keep field values standardized across objects.
- The design keeps information organized into logical objects instead of one large record.

3.5 Design Goals

- Centralize customer, employer and enterprise records.
- Reduce duplicate and invalid data through validation rules.
- Provide controlled access using profiles and permission sets.
- Automate order quantity, billing calculations and birthday offer emails.
- Make sales information easy to report and visualize.
- Create a scalable structure for future features such as mobile CRM, AI-based sales prediction and multi-branch support.

